Johannes Hollenbach

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Fields

- Primary: Health economics
- Secondary: Labor and education economics

Current Positions

- Paderborn University • Research Associate, Chair of Empirical Economics • since 2024
- RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • Researcher • since 2021

Education

- Paderborn University • PhD in Economics (Dr. rer. pol.) • since 2022
  Dissertation title: "How Endowments and Policies Shape Major Life Decisions and Healthy Aging"
  Advisor: Hendrik Schmitz
- University of Bayreuth • MSc in Economics • 2021
- University of Bayreuth • BA in International Economics and Development • 2018

Publications

- Hollenbach, J., Schmitz, H., and Westphal, M. "Gene-Environment Interactions with Essential Heterogeneity." *The Economic Journal* (forthcoming).
- Hollenbach, J., Schmitz, H., and Tawiah, B. "Life-Cycle Health Effects of Compulsory Schooling." *The European Journal of Health Economics* 27(6) (2026).
- Guthmuller, S., Heger, D., Hollenbach, J., and Werbeck, A. "The Impact of Retirement on Loneliness in Europe." *Scientific Reports* 14(1) (2024).
- Geissler, A., Hollenbach, J., Haring, M., Amelung, V., Thun, S., and Haering, A. "A Nationwide Digital Maturity Assessment of Hospitals: Results from the German DigitalRadar." *Health Policy and Technology* 13(4) (2024).
- Vogel, J., Hollenbach, J., Haering, A., Augurzky, B., and Geissler, A. "The Association of Hospital Profitability and Digital Maturity: An Explorative Study Using Data from the German DigitalRadar Project." *Health Policy* 142 (2024).

Work in Progress

- Genetic Endowments and the Long-Run Health Returns to Compulsory Schooling
  Job Market Paper
  Genetic differences tied to educational attainment predict later-life success and wellbeing. I study whether they also moderate how education affects physical health in old age. Using data on individuals aged 65 to 85 from the English Longitudinal Study of Ageing, I exploit the 1947 raising of the school leaving age in the UK from 14 to 15 in a fuzzy regression discontinuity setting to estimate the causal effect of schooling on frailty, the share of age-related health deficits. I estimate interactions with an educational attainment polygenic index (EA PGI), a DNA-based measure of genetic propensity for education. Health returns to schooling rise monotonically along the EA PGI, from zero in the lowest quintile to a 6 percentage point reduction in frailty in the highest. This gradient points to a complementarity between genetic endowments and education. These health improvements originate at the upper part of the frailty distribution. Suggestive evidence on channels indicates reduced smoking, higher physical activity, and a lower probability of receiving a disability pension.

VISITS

- University of Wisconsin–Madison • La Follette School of Public Affairs • Fall 2024
  Host: Jason Fletcher
- Vienna University of Economics and Business • Institute for Social Policy • Fall 2021
  Host: Sophie Guthmuller

AWARDS & GRANTS

- Research Exchange Scholarship • RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • 2024
- Travel Grant • German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) • 2024

INVITED TALKS

- Health Insurance Committee Meeting • German Health Economics Association • Fall 2026
- Applied Micro Workshop • University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee • Fall 2024
- Initiative in Social Genomics • University of Wisconsin–Madison (online) • Spring 2024

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

- 2026 • German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Wuppertal), European Social Science Genetics Network Conference (Bologna), Leibniz Resilient Ageing Workshop (Halle)
- 2025 • RWI Brown Bag (Essen), German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Paderborn), University of Duisburg-Essen Micro Workshop (Kamen)
- 2024 • ASSA Annual Meeting (San Antonio), Initiative in Social Genomics (UW–Madison), European Health Economics Association PhD & Supervisor Conference (Lucerne), CINCH-dggö Academy in Health Economics (Essen), German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Halle), Center for Economic and Statistical Analysis Young Researcher Workshop (Hagen)
- 2023 • European Health Economics Association PhD & Supervisor Conference (Bologna), CINCH-dggö Academy in Health Economics (Essen)
- 2022 • European Health Economics Association PhD & Supervisor Conference (Galway), European Health Economics Association Conference (Oslo), Economics of Mental Health Workshop (Essen), German Health Economics Association Annual Meeting (Hamburg), RWI Brown Bag (Essen)

REFEREEING

Health Economics, Health Policy and Technology, The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy, The European Journal of Health Economics

TEACHING (AS TEACHING ASSISTANT)

- Master Thesis Supervision • Paderborn University • since 2024
- Statistics (undergraduate) • Paderborn University • Summer 2025
- Microeconometrics (graduate) • Paderborn University • Summer 2024, Summer 2025
- Empirical Economics (undergraduate) • Paderborn University • Summer 2024
- Healthcare Systems (graduate) • University of Duisburg-Essen • Summer 2024

OUTREACH & SERVICE

- Early Career Representative • Leibniz ScienceCampus “Skills over the Lifecycle” • since 2026
- PhD Representative (elected) • RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research • since 2025
- Scientific Partner • Young Economic Solutions • 2022, 2023

FURTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- University of Bayreuth • Student Assistant, Chair of Development Economics • 2018–2021
- University of Bayreuth • Student Assistant, Chair of Institutional Economics • 2018–2021

AFFILIATIONS & MEMBERSHIPS

American Economic Association (AEA), German Health Economics Association (dggö)

REFERENCES

- Hendrik Schmitz • Professor of Economics • Paderborn University
  hendrik.schmitz@uni-paderborn.de
- Matthias Westphal • Professor of Economics • FernUniversität in Hagen
  matthias.westphal@fernuni-hagen.de
- Ansgar Wübker • Professor of Economics • Hochschule Harz
  awuebker@hs-harz.de